subsection with a working assumption that, like Messflix, your organization does not have any data governance in place.

WHY DO YOU NEED A DATA GOVERNANCE TEAM?

A *data governance team* is a group of people who will decide on data-related policies. They'll have to make decisions, driving the data products' design into interoperability with existing systems and with each other. We will explain the role of the data governance team at the MVP stage in section 3.3, and we'll expand on that in chapter 6.

WHOM DO YOU NEED ON A DATA GOVERNANCE TEAM?

You want people who understand the data journey, from data generation/acquisition to its actual business use. Therefore, it's of paramount importance to include stakeholders from multiple areas of the organization—from IT to affected business departments to management. Of course, you want to have at least one representative of your implementation team, but you don't want your governance team to be just a different label for your implementation team.

All that is no more than four or five people. Fewer participants create the perception that your governance is overly centralized (we do our best to avoid words like *dictatorship*), and more would be impractical to coordinate. Even a kickoff meeting between more participants could take more time than the promised month. Ensuring the time availability of prospects is of paramount importance.

NOTE Throughout this chapter, we will avoid specifying your central data governance team with a particular naming convention or in an exact position in the organizational chart. Instead, in chapter 6, we propose a central governance structure based on three separate bodies.

HOW DO YOU SELECT A DATA GOVERNANCE TEAM?

We would like to start with you stopping for a second and resetting your thinking about the teams and their roles in implementing the MVP.